BEHAVIOR DESIGN

Tiny Habits

The Small Changes That Change Everything

BJ Fogg, PhD · 2019

The founder of Stanford's Behavior Design Lab explains why big changes rarely stick, and how starting absurdly small, in the right spot in your day, makes new habits grow on their own.[1,2]

WHY READ IT

- A simple model that explains why any behavior does or doesn't happen[3]
- A step-by-step method you can use on any habit, at home or at work[1,6]
- Dozens of real stories from people who used it, with recipes you can copy[1]

GET THE BOOK

Tiny Habits by BJ Fogg, PhD

Houghton Mifflin Harcourt, 2019. At your local bookshop, your library, or as an audiobook.

A free guide inspired by *Tiny Habits* by BJ Fogg, PhD. Not affiliated with the author or publisher.

Please read the book

THE BIG IDEA

Start tiny, and make it feel good

Fogg argues that relying on motivation is a trap, because it rises and falls like a wave. Shrink a new habit until it's easy on your worst day, attach it to something you already do, and celebrate the moment you do it. The good feeling is what wires the habit in.[1,4,5]

THREE LESSONS

1 **Motivation is unreliable**

Use a high-motivation moment for one-off actions, like signing up or setting things up. For daily habits, rely on ease instead.[4]

2 **Emotions create habits**

Fogg's term for the feeling of success right after a behavior is Shine. A quick, genuine celebration does more to build a habit than repetition alone.[5]

3 **Help yourself feel successful**

Choose behaviors you actually want to do and can do, rather than ones you feel you should. Small wins build the confidence for bigger ones.[1,6]

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THE FRAMEWORK

The Fogg Behavior Model[3]

B = MAP

A Behavior happens when Motivation, Ability and a Prompt come together at the same moment. If a behavior isn't happening, one of the three is missing.[3]

1 Motivation

Your desire to do it

Real, but it rises and falls through the day in what Fogg calls the Motivation Wave.[4]

Try: Match yourself with behaviors you already want.[1]

2 Ability

How easy it is

Fogg's Ability Chain: time, money, physical effort, mental effort and fit with your routine. The weakest link decides how hard it feels.[6]

Try: Make it tiny: a Starter Step, or a scaled-back version.[6]

3 Prompt

What tells you to do it now

Three kinds: Person prompts (a feeling), Context prompts (something around you) and Action prompts (a routine you already do).[7]

Try: Use an Action prompt, which Fogg calls an Anchor.[7]

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FROM THE BOOK

Tools to try

The ABC recipe

Fogg's formula for a new habit: Anchor, Behavior, Celebration.[8,11]

1. Pick an Anchor: a routine you never skip, like starting the coffee machine.
2. Choose a tiny Behavior that takes under 30 seconds.
3. Write it as: After I [anchor], I will [behavior].
4. Celebrate right away, in a way that feels real to you.

Swarm and Focus Map

Fogg's way to pick the right behaviors for a goal.[6,10]

1. Write the outcome you want at the centre of a page.
2. Swarm it: list every specific behavior that could help.
3. Plot each one by impact and by how likely you are to do it.
4. Start with the Golden Behaviors: high on both.

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MAKE IT YOURS

Try it this week

1. Write one Tiny Habits recipe using the ABC formula.
2. Try Fogg's Maui Habit: each morning, as your feet touch the floor, tell yourself it's going to be a great day.[9]
3. Turn an annoyance into a cue, which Fogg calls a Pearl Habit.[6]
4. After seven days, notice which recipe stuck, and scale it up a little.

REFLECT

Which habit have you been trying to start with willpower alone?

What's the smallest version of it you'd do even on your worst day?

Try it in Sedi: Save your recipe as a Routine in Timely. The little sound when you tick it is a ready-made celebration.

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READ THE BOOK

🌱 Tiny Habits

BJ Fogg, PhD · Houghton Mifflin Harcourt · 2019

This guide only scratches the surface. The book has the research, the stories and the nuance behind every idea here. Buy it from an independent bookshop, borrow it from your library, or listen to the audiobook.

A NOTE FROM ME

I'm not affiliated with BJ Fogg, PhD or the publisher, and this guide isn't sponsored or endorsed by them. I've learned a lot from this book, so I'm sharing what I took from it, for free, in case it helps you too. Everything here is my own summary, in my own words. The good ideas are the author's; any mistakes are mine.

The maker of Sedi

SOURCES

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